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DATA INTERPRETATION SUPPORT

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ResearchEdit4U

Interpretation Help
Sample Report

From statistical outputs to clear research narrative, decision-ready insights, and thesis-friendly reporting

Sample topic

Association of sleep quality and perceived stress with academic performance among postgraduate students

What this sample demonstrates

- How a client’s output tables are translated into plain-English interpretation
- How each finding is mapped back to the research question
- How ready-to-use results text can be drafted for thesis, dissertation, or manuscript writing
- How an insight map helps the client quickly understand the story behind the numbers

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Prepared as a demonstration sample for the Interpretation Help service

1. Client brief snapshot

Research question	Do sleep quality and perceived stress significantly influence academic performance among postgraduate students?
Objectives	1) Describe the level of sleep quality, stress, and GPA in the sample. 2) Examine the correlations among key variables. 3) Identify whether sleep quality and stress predict GPA when other factors are considered.
Client-provided outputs	Descriptive statistics table, Pearson correlation matrix, multiple linear regression output, and model summary.
Sample and design	Cross-sectional survey of 120 postgraduate students.
Variables	Dependent variable: GPA. Independent variables: sleep quality score, perceived stress score, average daily study hours, and year of study.

2. Raw output tables received from client

Table 1. Descriptive statistics

Variable	Mean	SD	Minimum	Maximum
Sleep quality score (0-21)	12.8	3.4	5	20
Perceived stress score (0-40)	21.6	5.1	9	34
Daily study hours	3.7	1.2	1.0	7.0
GPA (0-10)	7.46	0.88	5.2	9.3

Table 2. Pearson correlation matrix

Variable	1	2	3	4
1. Sleep quality score	-	-.48***	.34***	.46***
2. Perceived stress score	-.48***	-	-.29**	-.52***
3. Daily study hours	.34***	-.29**	-	.31**
4. GPA	.46***	-.52***	.31**	-

Note. ** $p < .01$; *** $p < .001$

Table 3. Multiple linear regression predicting GPA

Predictor	B	SE	Beta	t	p value
Constant	6.12	0.54	-	11.33	< .001
Sleep quality score	0.07	0.02	0.29	3.41	.001
Perceived stress score	-0.08	0.02	-0.36	-4.28	< .001
Daily study hours	0.18	0.07	0.19	2.56	.012

Model summary: $F(3, 116) = 21.84$, $p < .001$; Adjusted R-squared = .34. The model explains 34% of the variance in GPA.

3. Plain-English interpretation of the outputs

Table 1: Descriptive statistics

The average GPA in the sample was 7.46, indicating a moderate to good academic performance overall. The mean sleep quality score suggests that students reported mixed sleep experiences, while the mean stress score indicates a noticeable level of perceived stress in the group. The spread of scores shows that participants varied enough for meaningful comparison across students.

Table 2: Correlation matrix

Sleep quality was positively associated with GPA ($r = .46$, $p < .001$). This means that students who reported better sleep tended to have higher academic performance. Perceived stress was negatively associated with GPA ($r = -.52$, $p < .001$), showing that higher stress tended to accompany lower academic performance. Study hours were positively linked with GPA ($r = .31$, $p < .01$), although this relationship was weaker than the relationship of GPA with stress and sleep.

Table 3: Regression analysis

When all predictors were considered together, stress remained the strongest predictor of GPA (Beta = -0.36, $p < .001$). Sleep quality also made a significant positive contribution (Beta = 0.29, $p = .001$), and daily study hours contributed a smaller but still significant positive effect (Beta = 0.19, $p = .012$). Together, the predictors explained 34% of the variation in GPA, which indicates a meaningful model for social science research.

4. How to write these findings in the Results section

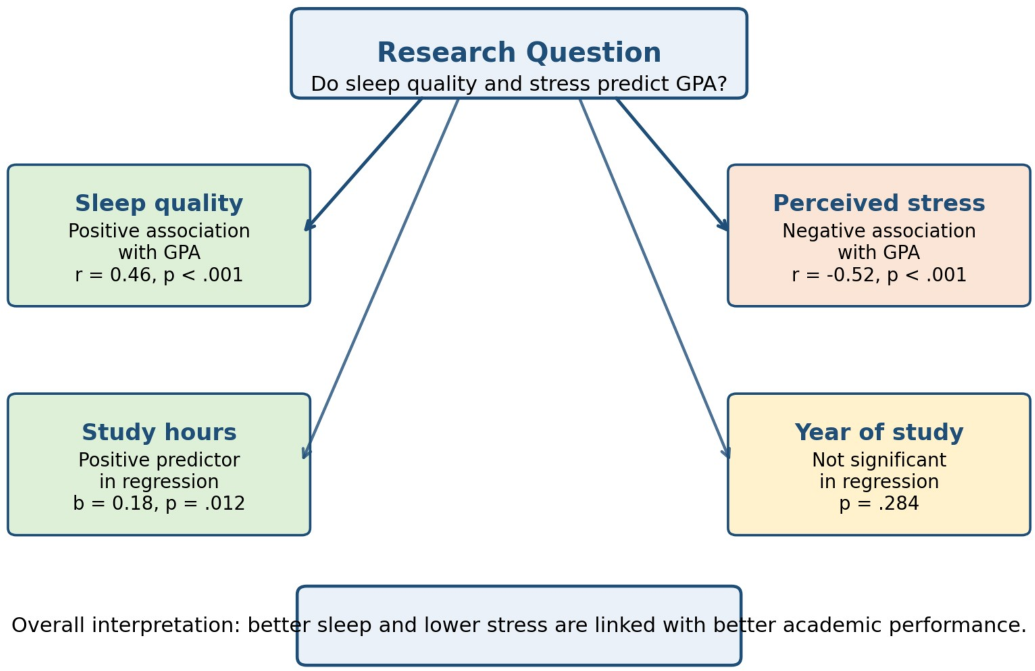
Descriptive analysis showed that the participants had a mean GPA of 7.46 (SD = 0.88), a mean sleep quality score of 12.8 (SD = 3.4), and a mean perceived stress score of 21.6 (SD = 5.1). Pearson correlation analysis revealed that GPA was positively associated with sleep quality ($r = .46$, $p < .001$) and daily study hours ($r = .31$, $p < .01$), while it was negatively associated with perceived stress ($r = -.52$, $p < .001$). A multiple linear regression model was then conducted to examine whether sleep quality, perceived stress, and study hours predicted GPA. The overall model was significant, $F(3, 116) = 21.84$, $p < .001$, and explained 34% of the variance in GPA (Adjusted R-squared = .34). Perceived stress emerged as the strongest negative predictor of GPA ($B = -0.08$, Beta = -0.36, $p < .001$), while sleep quality was a significant positive predictor ($B = 0.07$, Beta = 0.29, $p = .001$). Daily study hours also showed a positive contribution to GPA ($B = 0.18$, Beta = 0.19, $p = .012$).

5. Research question mapping

Research question / objective	Relevant output	Interpretation	Direct answer
What is the general level of sleep, stress, and GPA in the sample?	Descriptive statistics	Participants show moderate GPA, mixed sleep quality, and noticeable stress.	The sample has meaningful variation and is suitable for interpretation.
Is sleep quality related to	Correlation matrix;	Better sleep is associated	Yes. Sleep quality is a

academic performance?	regression output	with higher GPA, even after controlling for other variables.	significant positive predictor.
Is stress related to academic performance?	Correlation matrix; regression output	Higher stress is linked with lower GPA and has the strongest effect in the model.	Yes. Stress is a significant negative predictor.

6. Insight map



Key takeaway

The outputs tell a clear story: students who sleep better and experience less stress tend to perform better academically. Among all predictors, perceived stress appears to be the strongest barrier to higher GPA in this sample. This means the client can discuss the results not only in statistical terms, but also in practical student-support terms.

7. Discussion support notes

- The finding that sleep quality predicts GPA suggests that academic performance is influenced by lifestyle and recovery patterns, not just study time.
- The strong negative role of stress indicates that interventions focused on stress management may be academically relevant.
- Because this is a cross-sectional dataset, the results support association rather than cause-and-effect claims.
- The model explains 34% of GPA variance, which is meaningful, but it also implies that additional factors such as motivation, attendance, prior academic ability, and family context may matter.

Reporting caution: Statistical significance does not automatically imply practical significance. Interpretation should always consider the study design, sample characteristics, and the theoretical context of the research problem.

8. What the client receives through this service

- Clear interpretation of each output table in simple academic English
- Research-question-wise answer mapping
- Ready-to-use results narrative for thesis, dissertation, or manuscript drafting
- Insight map summarising the main findings
- Discussion support notes and reporting cautions

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THANK YOU

DATA INTERPRETATION SUPPORT TOOLKIT

A practical support framework to help you understand your findings, explain them logically, and connect them meaningfully to your research objectives.

This toolkit helps strengthen
finding interpretation • trend explanation • result meaning • objective-wise understanding • analytical clarity • discussion direction • research relevance

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